

Action Research Plan

Name	Melissa Alexander-Blythe
Your Research Question	How does coaching an AP U.S. Government and Politics teacher to use AP Classroom in a collaborative way affect student engagement and metacognitive thinking over a three-week period?
Your role as a researcher	• Coach & Model – demonstrate AP Classroom collaborative lessons • Co-plan weekly lessons with the teacher observe one class per week • Provide feedback and coaching notes.
Scope	Three-week project focused on using AP Classroom progress checks and topic questions collaboratively to improve AP Gov student engagement and metacognition.
Research site and participants	Site: Dunbar High School, Fort Worth ISD. Participants: One AP Gov teacher and the entire AP Gov class (about 25–30 students).
Data collection procedures	1. AP Classroom Progress-Check Scores – Pre-test in Week 1 and post-test at end of Week 3. 2. Engagement Observation Checklist – weekly observation of student collaboration, peer questions, and evidence of students explaining their reasoning. 3. Student Metacognition Exit Tickets – short prompts after each collaborative lesson (e.g., strategies used, group help, changes for next time). 4. Teacher Reflections – weekly 10-minute interview and notes on engagement and metacognition. 5. Researcher Coaching Log – record of planning sessions and feedback.

Dates/Times to collect data	Baseline: 10/07/25 09:00 AM – Pre-test Progress Check During Action Research: 10/09/25 09:00 AM – Observation #1, Exit Ticket #1, Teacher Reflection #1 10/16/25 09:00 AM – Observation #2, Exit Ticket #2, Teacher Reflection #2 10/23/25 09:00 AM – Observation #3, Exit Ticket #3, Teacher Reflection #3 Final: 10/25/25 09:00 AM – Post-test Progress Check
Validity and reliability	Multiple data sources (scores, observations, student reflections, teacher reflections, coaching log) confirm patterns. Member check: share summary findings with the teacher to verify accuracy. Secure, password-protected storage for all data.
Ethical considerations	No IRB required because this is a class project. Obtain principal/site approval. Inform students and parents that reflections are voluntary and anonymous. Use codes instead of names in all notes and reports.
To-do list	1. Confirm class project status with professor – by 9/23/25. 2. Obtain principal/site approval – by 9/23/25. 3. Finalize observation checklist and exit-ticket prompts – by 10/03/25. 4. Collect baseline AP Classroom scores – 10/07/25. 5. Model first collaborative lesson – Week of 10/07/25. 6. Conduct weekly observations and coaching – 10/09, 10/16, 10/23. 7. Collect post-test scores – 10/25/25. 8. Analyze data and draft report – by 11/08/25.

